

Every operational improvement starts with measurement.

I recently designed a measurement framework and executive dashboard to establish a baseline before introducing a new newcomer engagement process.

Project Objective

Design a measurable newcomer operations framework that standardises follow-up, improves visibility across the onboarding journey, and enables future process optimisation through KPI-driven reporting.

The project involved:

- **Designing a structured data collection process**
 - **Defining operational KPIs**
 - **Building automated reporting in Power BI**
- **Mapping the newcomer journey from first visit through ongoing engagement**
- **Creating executive dashboards to support decision-making**

Rather than relying on assumptions, the objective was to establish a clear baseline so the impact of future process improvements can be measured objectively.

Projects like this remind me that good operations isn't just about reporting numbers—it's about creating visibility that enables better decisions.

Executive Overview - Newcomer Retention Improvement Programme

This report establishes the baseline performance of the church's newcomer retention process before implementation of my redesigned onboarding and engagement programme. Future reporting will compare post-implementation results against this baseline to measure operational impact.

Business Problem

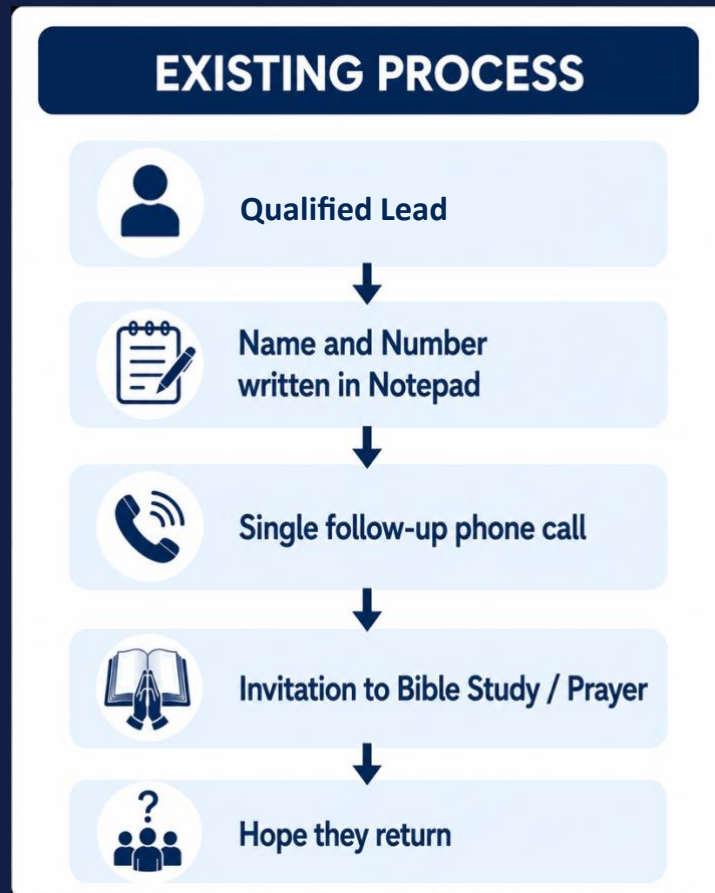
Current newcomer follow-up relies primarily on a single volunteer responsible for all follow-up activity. Although this provides an initial point of contact, the process is largely manual and inconsistent.

Current challenges include:

- Some newcomers receive no follow-up.
- Contact details are occasionally recorded incorrectly.
- Follow-up activity is difficult to monitor.
- There is no structured onboarding journey.
- There is limited visibility into where newcomers disengage.

As a result, newcomers may intend to return but fail to become integrated into the church community.

Existing Operational Process (Baseline)



The current process is dependent upon a single individual manually managing every newcomer.

Because the process is not standardised, service quality varies and there is no operational visibility into whether every newcomer receives a consistent experience.

The drawbacks of this approach are

- Single point of failure
- No SLA or follow-up ownership
- No visibility into pipeline progression

Executive Operational Dashboard (Power BI)

Built to monitor organisational health alongside lead acquisition, qualification, activation and retention using Google Forms, Google Sheets and Power BI. This dashboard establishes the baseline against which future improvements will be measured.

Executive Dashboard

Reporting Period (29 Mar – 28 Jun 2026)

Stack: Google Forms | Google Sheets | Power BI

Total Leads

50

Qualified Leads

24

Activated Customers

5

Retained Customers

2

Lead-to-Qualification

48.0 %

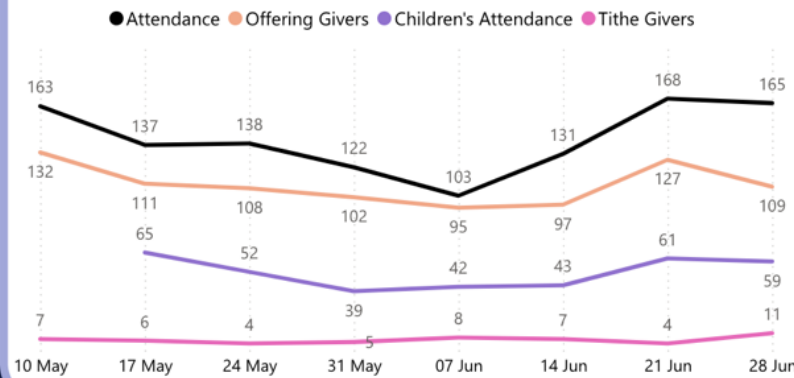
Lead-to-Activation

10.0 %

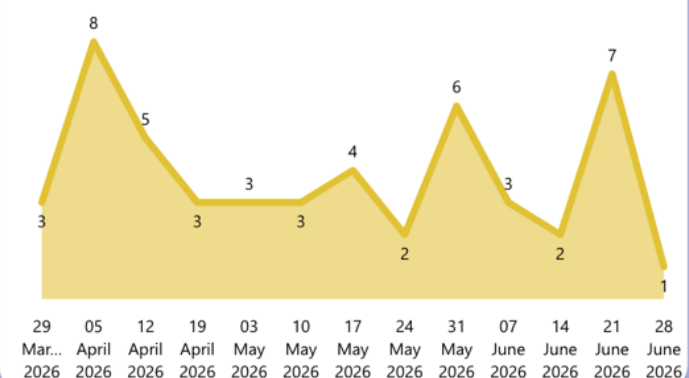
Lead-to-Retention

4.0 %

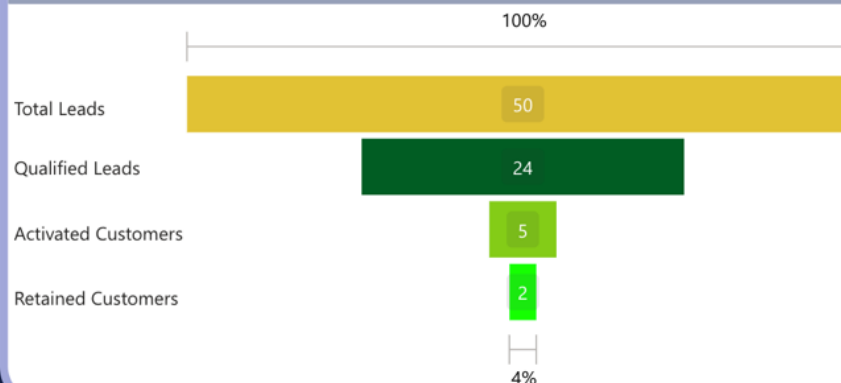
Existing Member Engagement (Weekly)



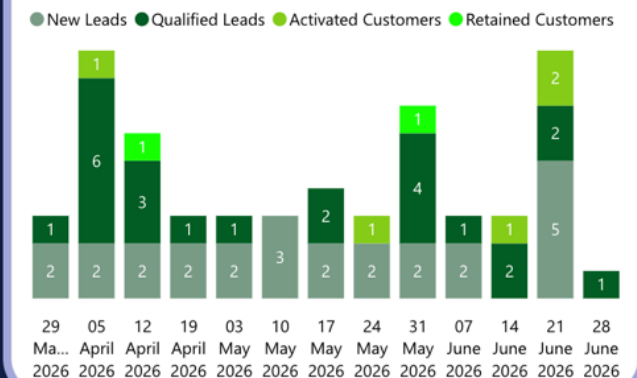
Lead Volume (Weekly)



Overall Lead Funnel



Lead Journey (Weekly)



- Are newcomer numbers increasing?
 - Where do people drop out?
- Which KPIs require intervention?

Customer Retention Dashboard

Total Leads

50

Qualified Leads

24

Activated Customers

5

Retained Customers

2

Lead-to-Qualification

48.0 %

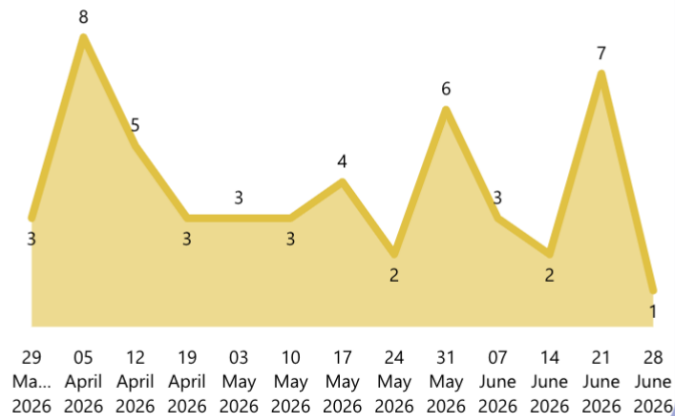
Lead-to-Activation

10.0 %

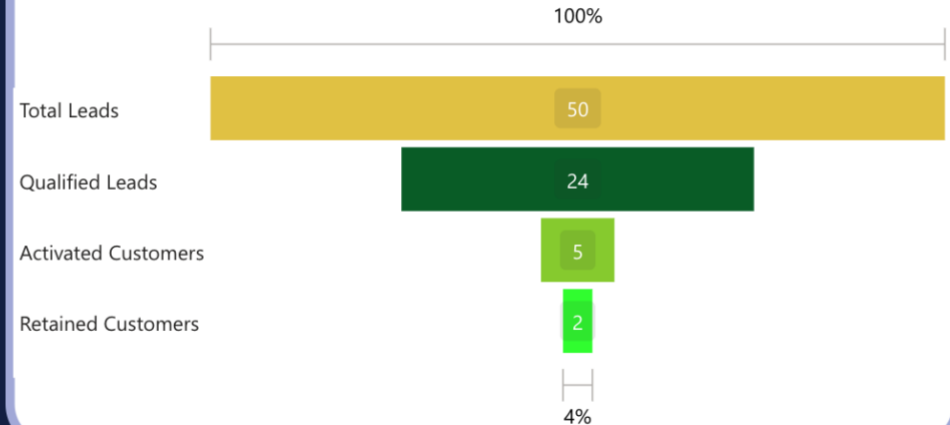
Lead-to-Retention

4.0 %

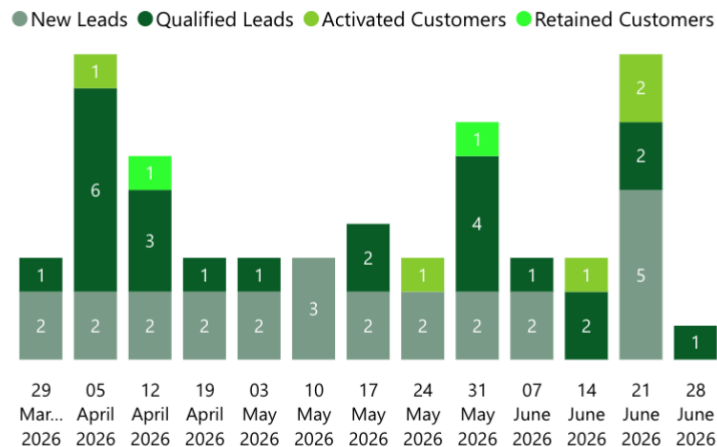
Lead Volume (Weekly)



Overall Lead Funnel



Lead Journey (Weekly)



Pipeline Filter

Visitor

Intended to Return

Returned Once

Returned Twice

Lead Records

Name	Phone Number	Initial Visit Date
Uddha	07875 94886	31 May 2026
Kulhar Abhinav Bhatnagar	07417 184401	31 May 2026
Shagun	07887 228671	07 June 2026
Arav		07 June 2026
AK	07886 434017	07 June 2026
Arav	07144 211385	14 June 2026
Charvi	07825 414162	14 June 2026
Shiv Durgam	07854 245132	21 June 2026
Shiv	07452 94886	21 June 2026
Arav		21 June 2026
Shiv Vishakh Menon	07440 88788	21 June 2026
Arav King	07429 684124	21 June 2026

This operational view enables coordinators to monitor weekly pipeline health, identify at-risk newcomers and drill into individual records requiring intervention.

Pipeline Conversion Analysis

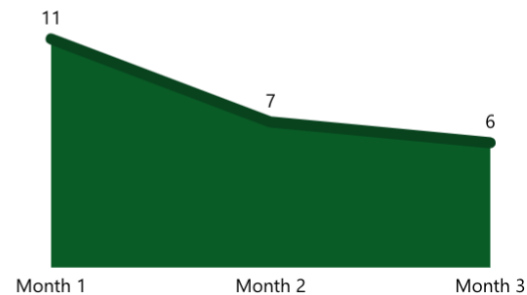
This page analyses Qualified Leads, measuring how efficiently they convert into Activated Customers and Retained Customers. The focus is on conversion performance after initial qualification.

Qualified Lead-to-Activation
20.8 %

Average Days to Activate
11 Days

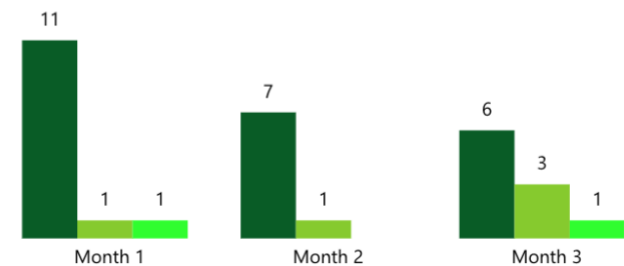
Qualified Lead-to-Retention
8.3 %

Qualified Lead Volume by Cohort



Qualified Lead Progression by Cohort

● Qualified Leads ● Activated Customers ● Retained Customers



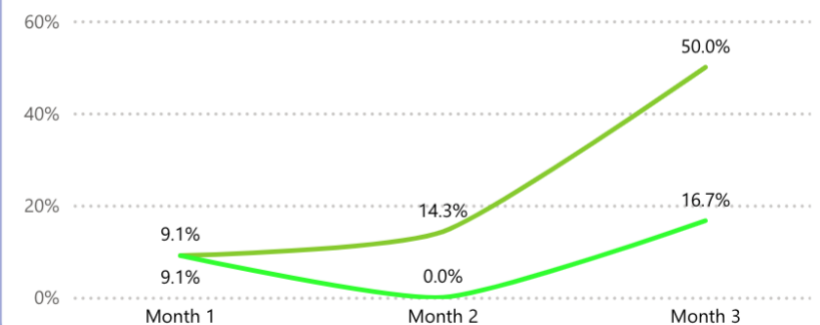
Qualified Lead Cohort Conversion Analysis

Cohort	Qualified Leads	Activated Customers	Retained Customers
Month 1	100.0 %	9.1 %	9.1 %
Month 2	100.0 %	14.3 %	0.0 %
Month 3	100.0 %	50.0 %	16.7 %

Every interaction with a qualified lead is a conversion opportunity. Effective engagement across key touchpoints helps move leads through the customer lifecycle with greater consistency. By optimising follow-up workflows and reducing friction between stages, organisations can improve qualification, activation and long-term retention. The objective is to build a repeatable process that consistently converts qualified leads into retained customers.

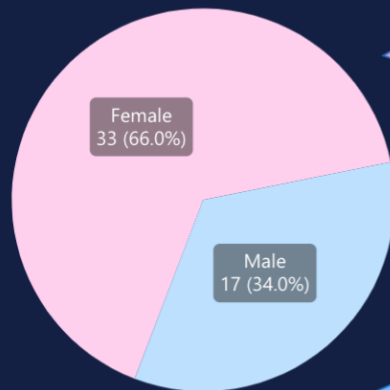
Qualified Lead Conversion Rates

● Activated Customers ● Retained Customers

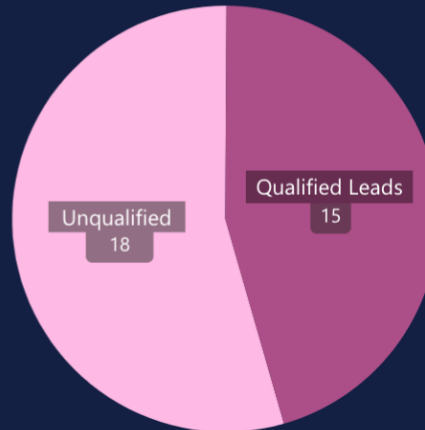


Pipeline Segmentation

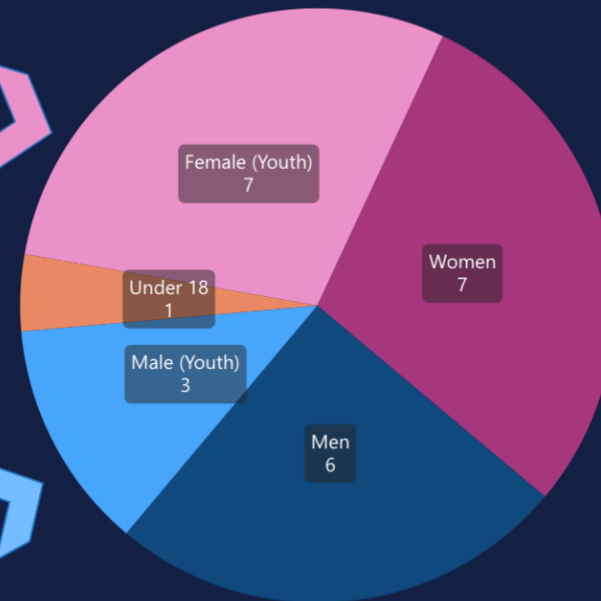
1. Gender of All Leads



2. Qualification by Gender



3. Qualified Lead Demographics

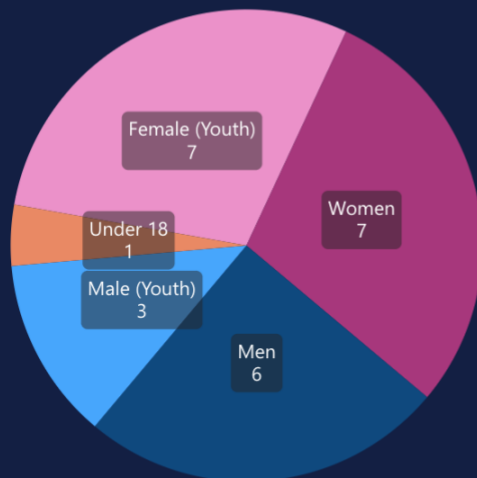


This page provides a segmentation view of the lead pipeline. Comparing overall lead demographics with qualification outcomes and lead segmentation helps identify where the highest concentrations of qualified leads exist. These insights provide the foundation for analysing which segments progress most effectively through the pipeline.

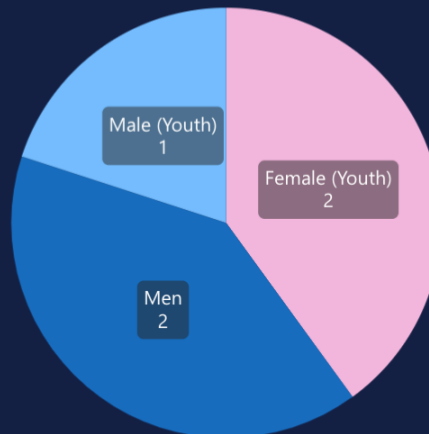
Segmenting newcomers helps identify which demographics convert most successfully, allowing future engagement strategies to be tailored accordingly.

Segmentation Performance Analysis

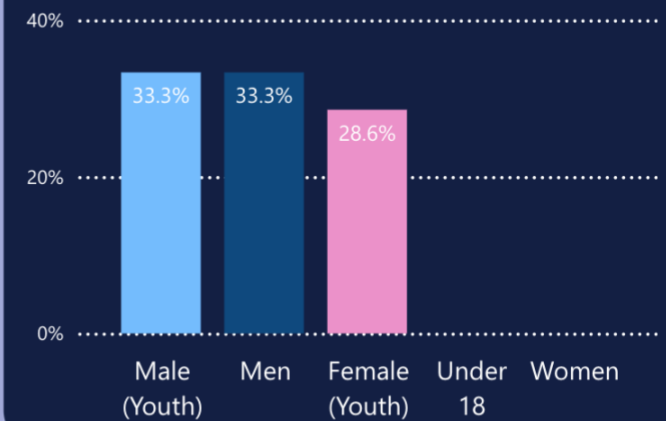
1. Qualified Lead Demographics



2. Activated Customer Segments



3. Activation Rates by Qualified Lead Segment

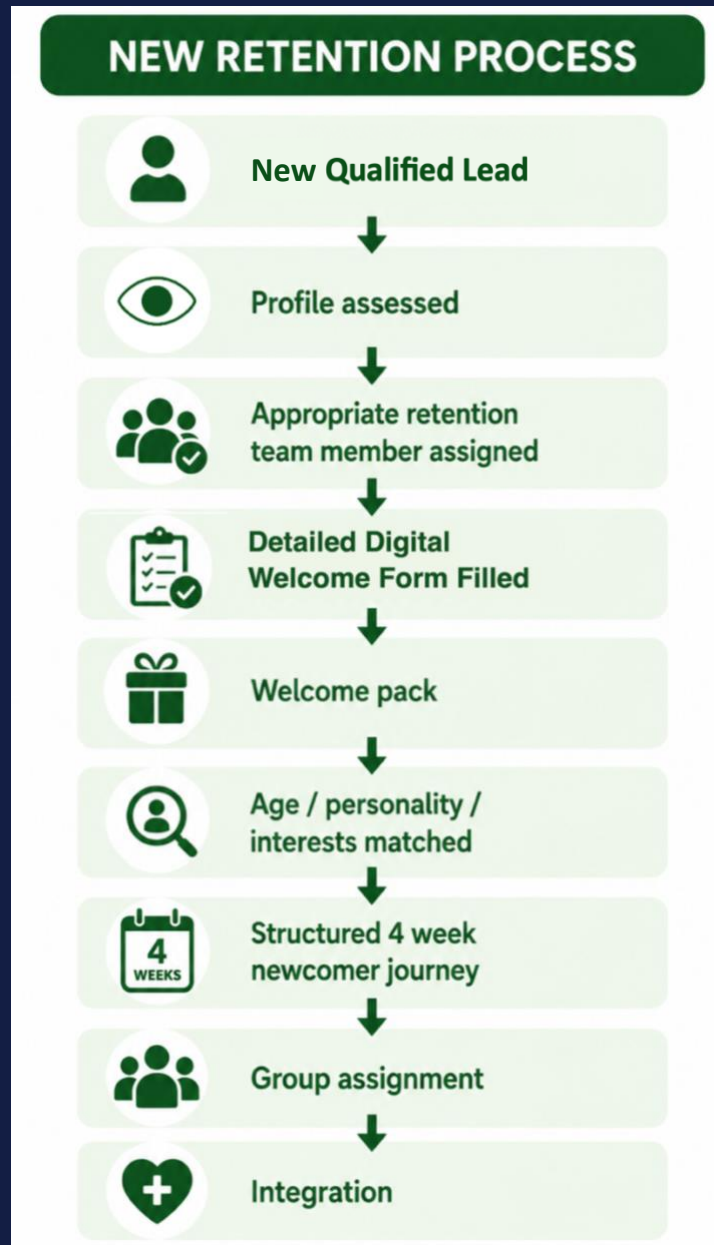


Qualified lead segments display different activation outcomes despite entering the pipeline at similar qualification levels. Monitoring segment-level activation rates helps identify where follow-up processes are most effective and where additional engagement or workflow optimisation may be required.

This analysis identifies where engagement strategies are performing well and where operational improvements may be required.

Future Operating Model

The proposed retention programme introduces a structured onboarding process designed to increase newcomer engagement and long-term retention.



Welcome Pack

1 Can of Drink £0.61p
Pack of 24 (£14.59)



1 Border Biscuit £0.33p
Pack of 60 (£20.10)



1 Book



1 Bookmark £0.07p
Pack of 100 (£6.99)



1 Welcome Booklet £0.60p
Pack of 100 (£59.99)



1 Welcome Bag £1.29p
Pack of 50 (£64.20)

Cost Per Welcome Pack = **£2.90**

Initial Procurement = **£165.87**
Cost

Key improvements include:

Dedicated Retention Team * Standardised Newcomer Journey * Welcome Pack
Group Assignment * Multiple Follow-up Touchpoints * Integration into Church Life

THE NEWCOMER JOURNEY

A 30-DAY PATHWAY TO CONNECTION, BELONGING & PURPOSE



OUR HEART

We don't just expect people to return,
we walk with them until they belong.



THE GOAL

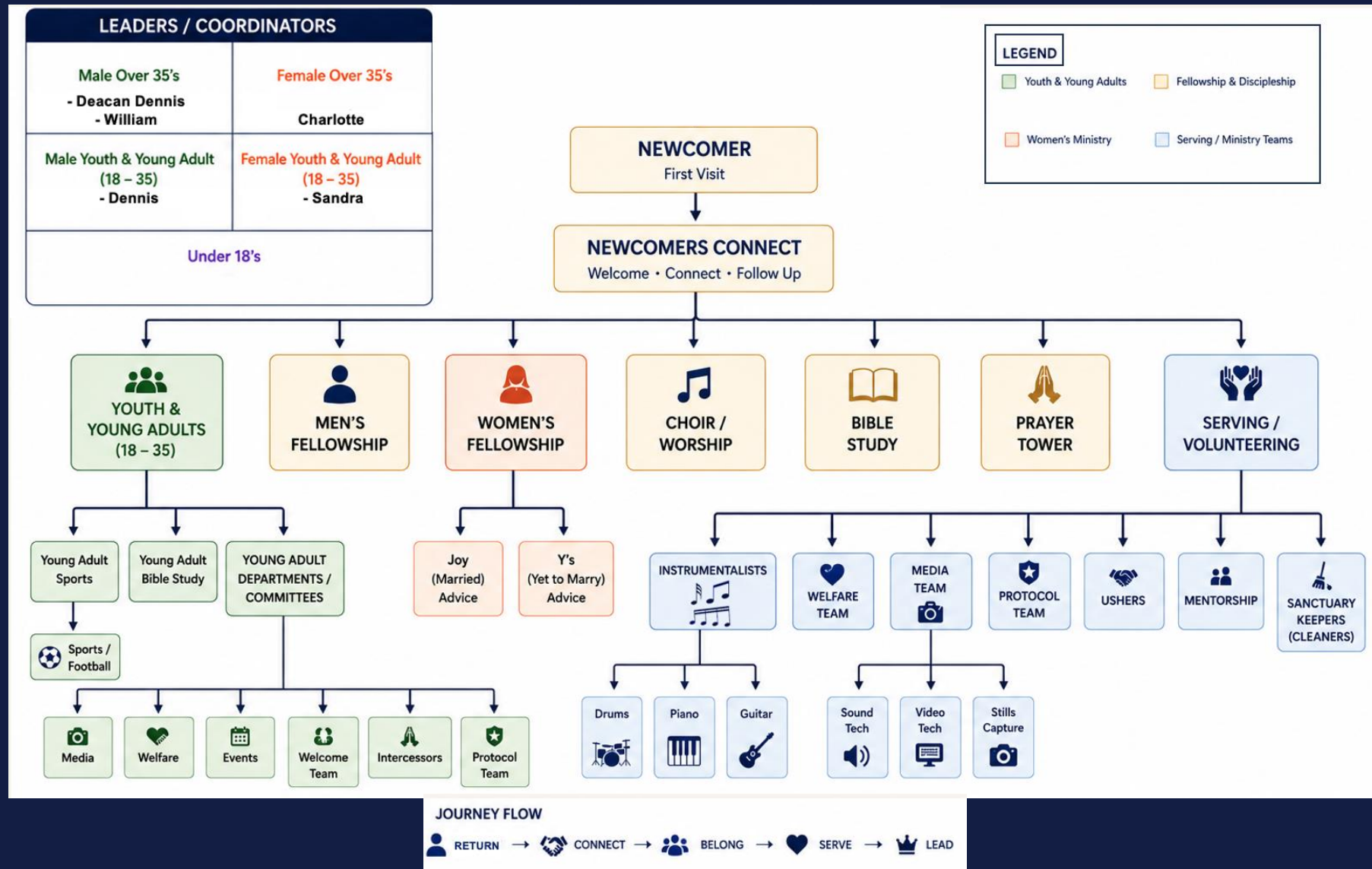
Every newcomer feels Welcomed,
Connected, and Equipped to
belong and serve.

TIMEFRAME	 SUNDAY	 SUNDAY EVENING (DAY 1)	 MIDWEEK (TUES/WED)	 THURSDAY	 SATURDAY
WEEK 1 WELCOME & FIRST STEPS 	- Warm welcome by someone who matches their profile - Friendly conversation - Form completed (digital or card) - Introduced to the Welcome Team	- Coordinator calls at 7pm to personally welcome them - Invite to newcomers coffee/tea/lunch - Find a day that suits them - Inform them about midweek activities (prayer, bible studies, etc.)	 Newcomer attends midweek activity (if possible)	- Church email sent - Warm welcome - This week's announcements - Encouragement to stay connected	- Coordinator calls or messages: <i>"We're looking forward to seeing you tomorrow, do you need a lift?"</i> - Offer transport assistance
WEEK 2 CONNECTION & BELONGING 	- Warm welcome back - Check in - Assign to a small group - Introduce to a friendly, active member in that group - Introduce to other newcomers		- Person in assigned group informally messages on WhatsApp - General conversation - Converse about the group in which they are in and how they go started, and most importantly what is needed 'serving wise' within that group - Invite to Bible study or prayers	- Church email sent - This week's announcements - Encourage midweek engagement	Group/coordinator member informally WhatsApp messages again: <i>"Looking forward to seeing you tomorrow, do you want us to organise a lift for you?"</i>
WEEK 3 RELATIONSHIP BUILDING 	- After service, meet all those in their group - Organise an informal meet up (lunch, coffee, hangout)		- Coordinator messages or calls - Coordinator Asks: Would you mind if we visited you to say hello? - General catch-up "Would you mind if we visit you to say hello?"	- Church email sent - This week's announcements - Highlight ways to get involved	Coordinator messages: <i>"We look forward to seeing you tomorrow. Need a lift?"</i>
WEEK 4 ENGAGEMENT & SERVING 	- During conversation, offer the newcomer an opportunity to serve within their group - Help them take the next step		- Encourage them in their new role or interest - Provide support and guidance	- Church email sent - This week's announcements - Celebrate involvement & community	Coordinator message: <i>"We appreciate you being part of the family. See you tomorrow!"</i>

Expected Outcomes

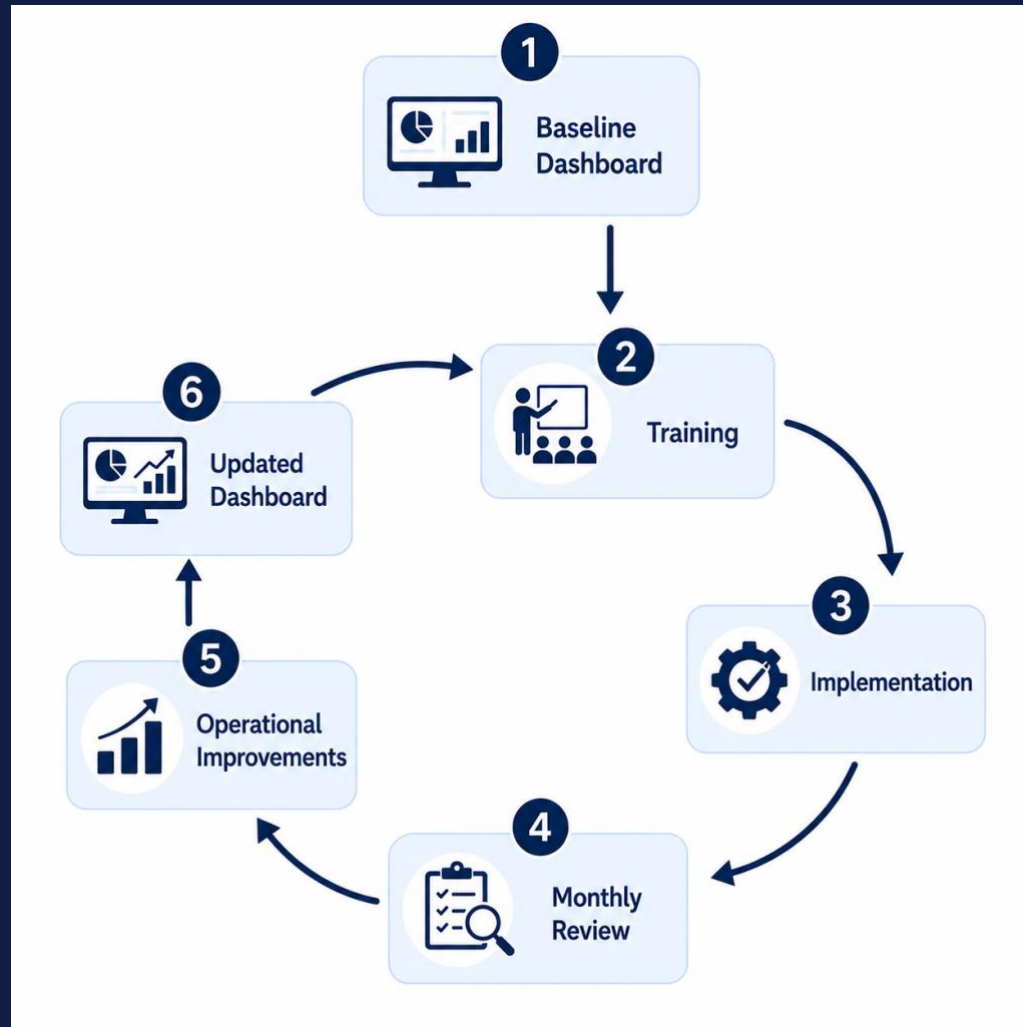
* Increased return rate * More consistent follow-up * Reduced volunteer dependency *
* Improved visibility * Faster intervention *

The Groups We Are Trying To Integrate Into



The objective is not simply to encourage attendance, but to guide newcomers into a group that they prefer and within meaningful communities where long-term retention is most likely.

Continuous Improvement Cycle



Governance & Success Measures

KPI	Current Baseline	Target
Lead-to-Qualification	48%	Increase
Qualification-to-Activation	23.8%	Increase
Qualification-to-Retention	9.5%	Increase
Average Time to Activate	11 Days	Reduce
Qualified Lead Volume	Monitor	Improve
Cohort Retention	Monthly	Improve

This framework has now been approved for implementation. Future dashboards will measure operational improvements against the baseline established in this report, **allowing** the church to measure whether operational improvements translate into improved newcomer engagement and retention.

Expected Operational Benefits

- Standardised onboarding experience
- Consistent follow-up across all newcomers
- Reduced dependency on a single coordinator
- Clear ownership across retention coordinators
- Increased visibility into pipeline performance
- Earlier identification of disengagement
- Greater integration into ministry groups
- Improved newcomer retention

The objective of this project is not simply to increase attendance, but to create a repeatable, measurable and scalable onboarding process that helps newcomers become connected members of the church community.

Operational Impact

This project demonstrates how operational thinking, structured processes and performance analytics can be applied beyond commercial environments. By combining process design, KPI development, Power BI reporting and workflow optimisation, the organisation now has a measurable framework capable of supporting continuous improvement.